Passermark – Variable Data

Numbers, texts from a table, QR code (business card, Wi-Fi, e-mail too), Code 128 and EAN-13 – in the program and on the command line · Passermark 1.11.4

Variable data places fields on a PDF and fills them anew for every page: sequential numbers, names from a table, QR and bar codes. The template stays as it is; everything is overlaid as vector graphics.

1 · How it works

Every field is a box on the page with a **content**. The content is fixed text, mixed with placeholders in double curly braces. This applies equally to text, QR code, Code 128 and EAN-13.

Placeholder	becomes	comes from
`{{nr}}`	the number, e.g. 0001	section 3 in the dialog (numbering): first number, digits, prefix, check digit
`{{i}}`	1, 2, 3 … (always without formatting)	running counter of the records
`{{Spaltenname}}`	the value of this column	the CSV file; first line = column names

Without braces it is plain text: `nr` prints "nr". Column names are case-insensitive. Double-clicking a column replaces a `{{nr}}` that is still unchanged.

More variables

In the dialog, the **?** button next to the content shows all variables with a sample value; double-click inserts one. Date and time are the moment of generating – the same for all pages. A CSV column with the same name always takes precedence.

Variable	yields
`{{datum}}`	today's date, e.g. 09.10.2026
`{{datum_iso}}`	Date as 2026-10-09
`{{zeit}}`	Time of generation, e.g. 14:30
`{{jahr}}`	Year, e.g. 2026
`{{monat}}`	Month, two digits, e.g. 10
`{{tag}}`	Day, two digits, e.g. 09
`{{wochentag}}`	e.g. Friday
`{{kw}}`	Calendar week
`{{datum:%d.%m.%y %H:%M}}`	Date/time with your own format (%d day, %m month, %Y year, %y two digits, %H hour, %M minute, %A weekday in English)
`{{seite}}`	Page number in the result
`{{seiten}}`	Page count of the result
`{{vorlagenseite}}`	Template page (1 or 2 for front/back)
`{{datensatz}}`	Record number (like {{i}})
`{{datensaetze}}`	Number of all records – e.g. “Card {{i}} of {{datensaetze}}”
`{{datei}}`	Template name without .pdf
`{{zufall}}`	random 6-digit number, new per field and page (recorded in the code log)
`{{zufall:10}}`	random number with 10 digits
`{{code:8}}`	random code of 8 capital letters and digits (no 0/O, 1/I)

Variable	yields
`{{uuid}}`	globally unique identifier

Field types

Type	What it may contain	Sample content	Watch out for
Text	anything, umlauts included	`Ticket {{nr}}`	font, size, colour, alignment in the dialog
QR code	anything: text, umlauts, web addresses – or, with a "type", business card, Wi-Fi, e-mail … from columns (section 4)	`https://…/{{nr}}`	is fitted squarely into the box, with a white margin (quiet zone); for web addresses from about 20 × 20 mm
Code 128	letters, digits, common characters – no umlauts	`T{{nr}}`	is stretched to the box width – make it wide (50–60 mm for 8–10 characters). Size = plain-text line below, 0 = none
EAN-13	exactly 12 or 13 digits	`{{EAN}}`	with 12 digits the check digit is added; with 13 the last digit is verified – wrong = error

How the records reach the pages

Setting (dialog / `order`)	Result
Every page gets the next record / `each`	Default. One-page template: one page per record. Multi-page template: page 1 → record 1, page 2 → record 2 …
One copy of the whole document per record / `record`	all pages with the same record, then the next copy (front and back of a card)
… sorted page by page / `page`	as above, but first all fronts, then all backs
Pages per record / `pages_per_record`	with "Every page …": that many pages belong together. **2 = front and back**: pages 1+2 → record 1, 3+4 → record 2 … – regardless of whether the template has 2 pages (it is repeated) or already 200 (100 cards)

Front and back different

Every field has "Only on these pages of the template": `ungerade` = odd (front), `gerade` = even (back), `1-50` = range, `ungerade 1-50` = odd within the range, several separated by commas. Example 100 business cards: "Pages per record" 2, field `{{Name}}` on `ungerade`, QR code on `gerade` (example 7).

Windows (page groups) – from Passermark 1.11

Every field belongs to a window, and every window determines on which pages of the template its fields appear. "All pages" is the base layer and applies everywhere (e.g. the event name on every card); further windows are added on their pages: `ungerade` (front pages), `gerade` (back pages) or a fixed page range such as `5-8`, which wins over odd/even for its pages. Create a window with **+ Add another window** (e.g. "Front pages (name)", "Back pages (QR code)"), rename directly in the box; **Remove current window** pulls its fields into the first window.

In the dialog (left, 1st window)	Meaning
Pages of this window	empty = all pages (base layer); `ungerade`, `gerade` or a range like `1,3-5` `or ungerade 1-50`
Window of the selected field	shows the field's window; select here to move it to another window. New fields land in the window chosen above
Result line	"{0} records → {1} pages" – plus a warning when pages are in no window ("– {0} pages without window!")

In the dialog (left, 1st window)	Meaning
Advanced: output ordering	`Sheet by sheet` = first all pages of record 1 (the way the printer stacks) · `Page by page` = first page 1 with all records · **Without duplicates**: per record the next "pages per record" of the template, without multiplication

Preview: green frame = declared trim size (TrimBox), dashed red frame outside = bleed; the adjustable inner frame is a placement aid. Old presets and the command line keep working unchanged: fields with "Only on these pages" are migrated to windows automatically on loading (identical page spec = one window).

2 · Fetching the examples

Passermark ships seven ready-made examples. "Fetch" copies them to the folder `Passermark-Beispiele/vdp` in your user folder and registers them as presets "Beispiel 1" to "Beispiel 7" (with the correct path to the table).

Where	How
Program	Menu **Help → Fetch variable-data examples …** or workspace **Variable data → Examples**. The template opens right away in a new tab.
Command line	`passermark-cli beispiele` – or `passermark-cli beispiele D:\Kurs` for a different folder

File	Contents
`vorlage-a6.pdf`	empty template A6 landscape – the fields go on it (examples 1–6)
`vorlage-karte-vorne-hinten.pdf`	business card 85 × 55 mm, page 1 front, page 2 back (example 7)
`vorlage-bogen-text.pdf`	Template for the editing mode: circular text “PASSERMARK” as from a design app, two overlapping rectangles, one straight line (section 8)
`daten.csv`	3 records: Name;Ort;Artikelnummer;EAN (examples 2–4)
`visitenkarten.csv`	3 contacts for the business card (example 5)
`wlan.csv`	3 Wi-Fi networks (example 6)
`presets/beispiel-*.json`	the settings of the seven examples
`ergebnis/beispiel-*.pdf`	this is what the result must look like
`LIESMICH.txt`	short version of this manual

Contents of `daten.csv`:

```
Name;Ort;Artikelnummer;EAN
Anna Huber;Wien;ART-1001;4006381333931
Bernd Gruber;Graz;ART-1002;978316148410
Clara Wimmer;Linz;ART-1003;5901234123457
```

3 · In the program – the workflow

1. Open the PDF that serves as the template (e.g. `vorlage-a6.pdf`).

2. Choose the **Variable data** workspace and click **Variable data** – or press `Ctrl+Shift+D`. The preview is on the left, the settings in four groups on the right.

3. 1. Fields on the page: create a field with **+ Text**, **+ QR code**, **+ Code 128** or **+ EAN-13**. Drag it in the preview or enter the position in mm under "Position and size" (left/top = distance from the page's top-left corner). Enter what goes inside under **Content of the selected field**.

4. 2. Where do the data come from? Without a table: leave "none – numbering only" and set the count. With a table: **Open CSV …** – the columns appear under "Placeholders to insert"; double-click inserts them into the selected field's content.

5. 3. Numbering – only needed when a content contains `{{nr}}`: first number, step, digits (zero-padded), text before/after, check digit.

6. Page through with **Page** / **Record** above the preview and check. Errors (e.g. a wrong EAN length) appear there instead of the code.

7. Generate (new tab) – the result opens as a new document. Then save or print it.

Keep settings: save them in the preset bar at the top of the dialog. Without a preset the dialog remembers the settings only until Passermark is closed. **Reset everything** starts over with an empty text field `{{nr}}`.

Multi-page templates: in 1. the fields are grouped by **windows (page groups)** – each window with its own page selection (see section 1). Front and back: two windows with `ungerade` and `gerade`.

4 · Entering data – the table inside Passermark

Instead of building the table in Excel, you can do it directly in Passermark: workspace **Variable data → Enter data** (or in the variable-data dialog under 2. **Enter data …**). For every kind the table brings the matching columns, checks each row immediately and shows the finished code of the selected row on the right.

1. Choose the **kind** at the top, e.g. "QR – business card (vCard)". Mandatory columns carry an *; hovering over a column header shows what belongs in it.

2. Fill in the rows – or copy from Excel/LibreOffice and paste with `Ctrl+V` (many rows and columns at once, too). **Duplicate row** saves typing when little changes.

3. Fill column … creates a number series (e.g. T0001 … T0100) and creates the rows along the way. **Add column …** for your own texts, e.g. "Table".

4. Under **Check** errors are listed with the row number (double-click jumps there): missing mandatory values, wrong EAN check digit, umlauts in Code 128, an unclear date …

5. Save creates a CSV (UTF-8, semicolon – Excel opens it correctly). **Use in variable data** saves the table and takes it over together with a matching field.

The CSV contains readable columns (first name, phone …), not the finished code content. Passermark assembles that when generating: a QR field gets a **QR code type** for this, e.g. "Business card (vCard)". This keeps the table editable in Excel.

Type	columns (* = mandatory)	what the phone does when scanning
QR – Business card (vCard)	Vorname, Nachname, Firma, Position, Telefon, Mobil, E-Mail, Straße, PLZ, Ort, Land, Web, Notiz	When scanned, the phone offers to save the contact.
QR – Wi-Fi access	Netzname*, Passwort, Verschlüsselung, Versteckt	After scanning, the phone connects to the Wi-Fi.
QR – E-mail	E-Mail*, Betreff, Text	Opens a new e-mail with recipient, subject and text.
QR – Web address	Adresse*	Opens the website.
QR – Phone call	Telefon*	The phone offers to call the number.
QR – SMS	Telefon*, Text	Opens an SMS with recipient and text.
QR – Event	Titel*, Beginn*, Ende, Ort, Beschreibung	The phone offers to add the event to the calendar.
QR – Location	Breite*, Länge*	Opens the place in the maps app.
QR – Free text	Inhalt*	The text goes into the QR code exactly as written.
Barcode – Code 128	Code*	For article, stock and ticket numbers.
Barcode – EAN-13	EAN*	Retail article number (registered with GS1) or internal 20…–29…
Text – own columns	Text	Create your own columns, e.g. Name, Table, Category.

Your own CSV with different column names

An existing table does not have to be renamed – e.g. a contact export from Outlook, Google or Thunderbird with English columns ("First Name", "Mobile Phone", "E-mail Address" …):

1. Open the template, variable data, under 2. **Open CSV …** → the file (in the examples folder: `kontakte-outlook.csv`).

2. Below it says what the table matches, e.g. "QR – business card (vCard)". **Create matching field** creates the QR code with that type – or choose the **QR code type** on your own QR field.

3. Below the type it shows what comes from where: "First name ← First Name, phone ← Business Phone …". If a mandatory value is missing or something does not fit: **Map columns …** – choose the column per value, "– leave empty –" or "automatic". The finished content of the first record is shown at the bottom.

4. Your own mapping is saved in the preset – the same kind of table works next time without rework, on the command line too.

Recognised are the names from section 4 and common others: English, Hungarian, Spanish, French as well as the header lines of contact exports from Outlook, Google and Thunderbird. Case, spaces and punctuation don't matter; "E-Mail-Adresse privat" also matches e-mail. The CSV itself is never modified.

Business card: first name, last name or company must be filled in. Event: start as `24.10.2026 18:00` or `2026-10-24 18:00`; date only = all day. Wi-Fi: encryption empty = WPA; without password = open network.

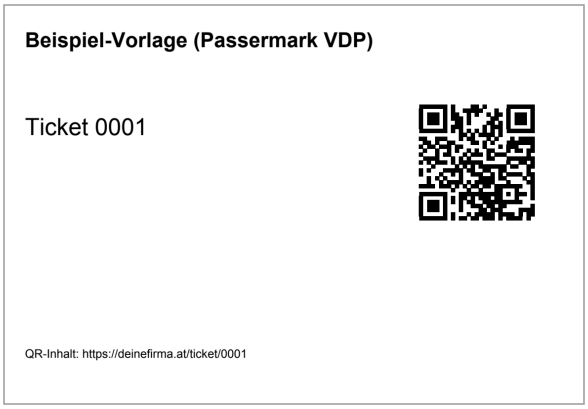
5 · The seven examples

Examples 1–6 use `vorlage-a6.pdf`, example 7 `vorlage-karte-vorne-hinten.pdf`. Position in mm: left, top, width × height. The small text lines in the examples are only there to check what is inside the code.

Example 1 – QR code with sequential number (no CSV)

5 tickets; every QR code contains its own web address.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
QR code	`https://deinefirma.at/ticket/{{nr}}`	100, 25, 35 × 35
Text	`Ticket {{nr}}`, 16 pt	10, 30, 60 × 8



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-1-qr-nummer.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Open the template, variable data (`Ctrl+Shift+D`), **Reset everything**.

2. Select the existing text field, content `Ticket {{nr}}`, size 16.

3. **+ QR code**, content `https://deinefirma.at/ticket/{{nr}}`, position 100 / 25 / 35 / 35.

4. 2.: "none – numbering only", number of records **5**.

5. 3.: first number 1, step 1, **4 digits** → 0001 … 0005.

6. Page through records 1–5, **Generate**.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 1 – QR mit Nummer" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

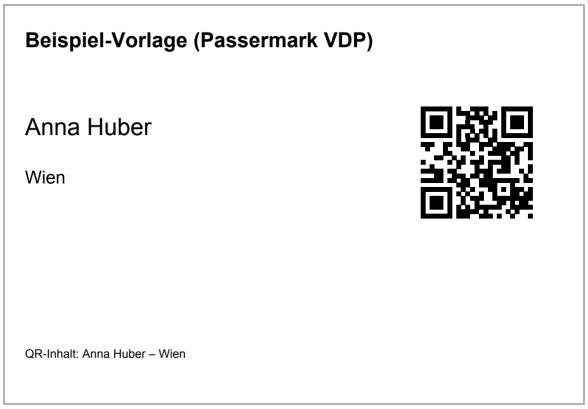
Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf tickets.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-1-qr-nummer.json
# 200 instead of 5 copies, starting at number 101:
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf tickets.pdf --preset "Beispiel 1 – QR mit Nummer" \
    --set count=200 --set numbering.start=101
```

Example 2 – QR code and text from the CSV

One card per CSV row; the QR code contains name and city (umlauts work).

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
QR code	`{{Name}} – {{Ort}}`	100, 25, 35 × 35
Text	`{{Name}}`, 16 pt	10, 30, 60 × 8
Text	`{{Ort}}`	10, 42, 60 × 8



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-2-qr-csv.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Open the template, variable data, **Reset everything**.

2. 2.: **Open CSV …** → `daten.csv`. Under "Placeholders to insert" you now find Name, Ort, Artikelnummer, EAN.

3. Select the text field, clear the content, double-click **Name** → `{{Name}}`; size 16.

4. + Text for `{{Ort}}`, position 10 / 42.

5. + QR code, content `{{Name}} – {{Ort}}` (double-click, type " – " in between).

6. Page through records 1–3, **Generate**.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 2 – QR aus CSV" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

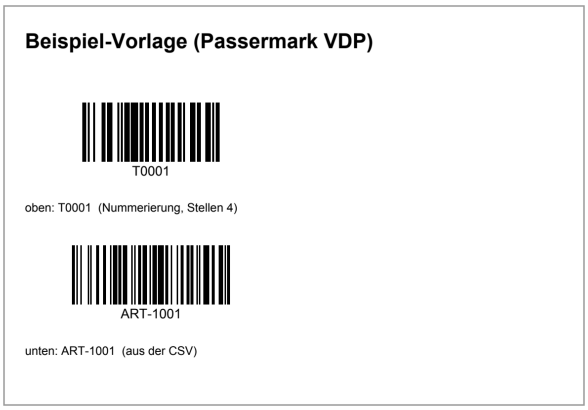
Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf karten.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-2-qr-csv.json
# a different table, only the first 50 rows:
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf karten.pdf --preset "Beispiel 2 – QR aus CSV" \
    --set csv_path=gaeste.csv --set records=1-50
```

Example 3 – Code 128 from the number and from the CSV

A code from letter + number at the top, the article number from the table at the bottom.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
Code 128	`T{{nr}}`, size 9	10, 28, 60 × 18
Code 128	`{{Artikelnummer}}`, size 9	10, 62, 60 × 18



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-3-code128.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Open the template, variable data, **Reset everything**, remove the text field with **Delete field**.

2. 2.: **Open CSV …** → `daten.csv`.

3. + Code 128, content `T{{nr}}`, position 10 / 28 / 60 / 18, size 9 (= plain text below; 0 = none).

4. 3.: **4 digits** → T0001, T0002, T0003.

5. + Code 128, content `{{Artikelnummer}}` (double-click), position 10 / 62 / 60 / 18.

6. Generate.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 3 – Code 128" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

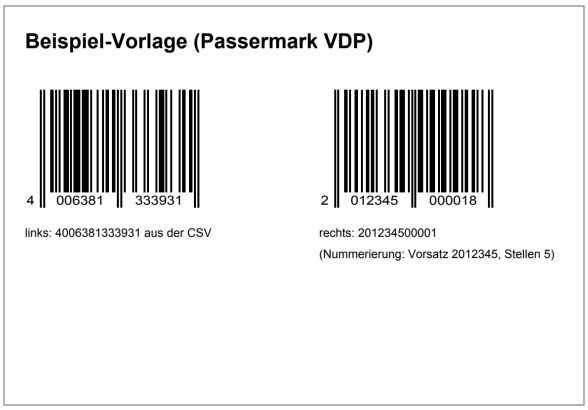
Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf etiketten.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-3-code128.json
```

Example 4 – EAN-13 from the CSV and from the numbering

Finished EANs from the table on the left (13 and 12 digits mixed), a self-generated internal number on the right.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
EAN-13	`{{EAN}}`	10, 25, 45 × 28
EAN-13	`{{nr}}` (prefix 2012345, 5 digits)	80, 25, 45 × 28



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-4-ean13.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Open the template, variable data, **Reset everything**, delete the text field.

2. 2.: **Open CSV …** → `daten.csv`.

3. + EAN-13, content `{{EAN}}`. Record 2 has only 12 digits (978316148410) – the check digit 0 is added.

4. + EAN-13, content `{{nr}}`, position 80 / 25 / 45 / 28.

5. 3.: text before **2012345**, **5 digits**, check digit **none** → 201234500001 (12 digits) → code 2012345000018.

6. Generate.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 4 – EAN-13" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

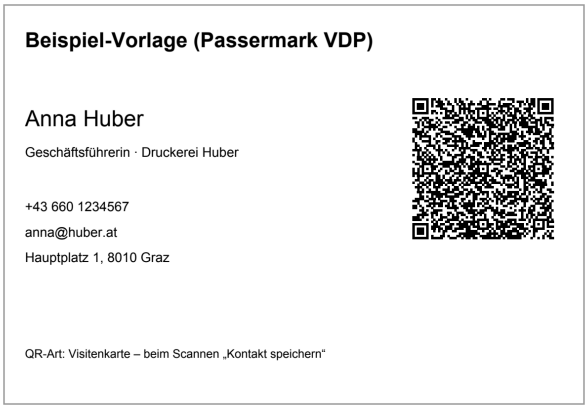
Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf ean.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-4-ean13.json
```

Example 5 – QR business card (vCard) from a contact list

One card per contact: name, role and contact details as text, plus a QR code with which the phone saves the contact.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
Text	`{{Vorname}} {{Nachname}}`, 15 pt	10, 28, 85 × 8
Text	`{{Position}} · {{Firma}}`, 9 pt	10, 37, 85 × 6
Text	`{{Mobil}}`, `{{E-Mail}}`, `{{Straße}}, {{PLZ}} {{Ort}}`	10, 50 / 56 / 62
QR code	Type "Business card (vCard)"	100, 25, 38 × 38



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-5-visitenkarte.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Enter data → type "QR – business card (vCard)" → enter contacts or open `visitenkarten.csv` → **Use in variable data**. The QR field with the business-card type is already there.

2. Drag the QR field into place, position 100 / 25 / 38 / 38.

3. Create text fields and insert the columns by double-clicking.

4. Page through records 1–3, **Generate**.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 5 – Visitenkarte (vCard)" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf karten.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-5-visitenkarte.json
# your own list:
passermark-cli datenvorlage vcard kontakte.csv        # empty table with the columns
passermark-cli datencheck kontakte.csv                # validate
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf karten.pdf \
    --preset presets/beispiel-5-visitenkarte.json --set csv_path=kontakte.csv
```

Example 6 – Wi-Fi access to scan

Table tent card or room card: network name and password readable, the QR code connects the phone directly.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
Text	`WLAN: {{Netzname}}`, 15 pt	10, 30, 85 × 8
Text	`Passwort: {{Passwort}}`, 10 pt	10, 42, 85 × 6
QR code	Type "Wi-Fi network"	100, 25, 38 × 38



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-6-wlan.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Enter data → type "QR – Wi-Fi network" → enter network name and password (encryption empty = WPA) → **Use in variable data**.

2. Create text fields, content `WLAN: {{Netzname}}` and `Passwort: {{Passwort}}`.

3. Generate – page 3 (Huber-Cafe, without password) yields an open network.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 6 – WLAN-Zugang" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

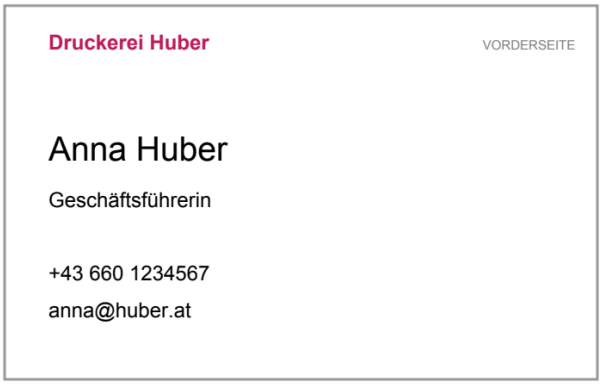
Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf wlan-karten.pdf --preset presets/beispiel-6-wlan.json
```

Example 7 – business card with front and back

Name and contact details on the front, a QR code for saving the contact on the back – both pages per contact. Result: pages 1/2 Anna, 3/4 Bernd, 5/6 Zoë.

Field	Contents	Position (left, top, W × H in mm)
Text	`{{Vorname}} {{Nachname}}`, 13 pt, pages `ungerade`	8, 18, 70 × 7
Text	`{{Position}}`, `{{Mobil}}`, `{{E-Mail}}`, pages `ungerade`	8, 26 / 36 / 41
QR code	Type "Business card (vCard)", pages `gerade`	27.5, 10, 30 × 30
Text	"Save contact", centred, pages `gerade`	8, 43, 69 × 5



Result page 1 (ergebnis/beispiel-7-karte-vorne-hinten.pdf)

Create it in the program itself

1. Open `vorlage-karte-vorne-hinten.pdf`, variable data, **Reset everything**.

2. 2.: **Open CSV …** → `visitenkarten.csv`.

3. Text field `{{Vorname}} {{Nachname}}` (double-click Vorname, space, Nachname); "Pages of this window" `ungerade` (front pages); likewise the other rows.

4. **+ Add another window** for the back pages, "Pages of this window" `gerade`, then **Create matching field** (QR code with the business-card type), position 27.5 / 10 / 30 / 30.

5. Page through records 1–3: page and record run along (record 2 = page 3), **Generate**.

Use the finished preset: choose "Beispiel 7 – Visitenkarte vorne und hinten" from the preset bar at the top of the dialog.

Command line (in the examples folder)

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-karte-vorne-hinten.pdf karten.pdf \
    --preset presets/beispiel-7-karte-vorne-hinten.json
# template with 200 pages (100 cards already designed), customer CSV:
passermark-cli vdp kunde-200-seiten.pdf fertig.pdf \
    --preset "Beispiel 7 – Visitenkarte vorne und hinten" --set csv_path=kunde.csv
```

EAN-13 for retail requires a number registered with GS1. For purely internal codes (warehouse, inventory) the number ranges 20–29 are reserved.

6 · On the command line

Create the fields in the program and save a preset; the command line uses it and changes only what differs per job. A preset is passed as a file or by its name from the preset bar.

```
passermark-cli beispiele                          # fetch examples + presets
passermark-cli presets vdp                        # list saved presets
passermark-cli datenarten                         # data kinds and their columns
```

```
passermark-cli datenvorlage wifi wlan.csv              # empty table with sample row
passermark-cli datencheck wlan.csv                     # validate (return code 1 on problems)
passermark-cli vdp <template.pdf> <result.pdf> --preset "<name or file>" [--set …]
```

Changing with --set	Example	Meaning
csv_path	--set csv_path=liste.csv	a different table
count	--set count=500	without CSV: that many records
records	--set records=1-50	only these rows of the table
numbering.start	--set numbering.start=101	first number
numbering.digits	--set numbering.digits=6	digits padded with zeros
numbering.prefix	--set numbering.prefix=A-	text before the number
numbering.continue_key	--set numbering.continue_key=Tickets	the next job continues counting there
order	--set order=record	each / record / page (section 1)
pages_per_record	--set pages_per_record=2	pages per record (front/back)
reverse	--set reverse=true	backwards (tear-off pad)
log_path	--set log_path=codes.csv	log: which page has which code

A relative csv_path in the preset (like daten.csv in the example files) is looked up in the current folder first, then next to the preset file.

Windows: without the setup checkbox for the search path, write the full path, e.g. "C:\Program Files\Passermark\passermark-cli.exe" vdp …. AppImage: ./Passermark-*.AppImage --cli vdp ….

Many cards on one sheet

First generate the data, then impose – every position gets the next page, the stacks stay in order after cutting:

```
passermark-cli vdp vorlage-a6.pdf tickets.pdf \
    --preset "Beispiel 1 – QR mit Nummer" --set count=400
passermark-cli impose tickets.pdf tickets-sra3.pdf --set sheet=SRA3 \
    --set step_repeat=true --set sr_sequence=true --set sr_stack=stack --set crop_marks=true
```

The same in the program: print the result → More options → Step & repeat → "Next page on every position".

7 · Typical errors

What happens	Cause / fix
It says "nr" or the column name everywhere	Braces missing: {{nr}}, {{Name}}
Every page has the same number	Set distribution to "Every page gets the next record"
The back has the next record instead of the same one	Set "Pages per record" to 2
The name appears on the back too	at the field, "Only on these pages": ungerade
EAN-13: error in the preview	The content does not yield 12 or 13 digits – e.g. letters in the prefix or too few digits (prefix + digits = 12) – or the 13th digit (check digit) is wrong; the message names the correct one
QR with a type: "Column … is empty or missing"	At the QR field, "Map columns …" – choose the column the value comes from; or the row is empty (the check in "Enter data" shows it)
Code 128 scans poorly	Make the box wider; do not print it scaled down

What happens	Cause / fix
QR code too fine	Make the box bigger or the content shorter (short web address); a business card with all details needs about 35 × 35 mm
The code does not read when it sits close to an image or colour	Keep "Keep a white margin (quiet zone)" switched on
Column not found	Check the name in the first CSV line; separator ; , or tab
Umlauts from the CSV wrong	Save the CSV as UTF-8 (Excel: "CSV UTF-8")
Command line: file not found (CSV)	Give `--set csv_path=` with the full path

Always check on a printout, with a scanner or phone, whether a code really reads.

8 · Post-processing: the editing mode

The **Editing** workspace (document manipulation → Edit text and layers, `Ctrl+E`) shows in three tabs what is on the selected page: **text lines**, **objects** (vector and image) and **layers**. Select a line or object in the list or directly on the page: its frame appears, dragging moves it, `Ctrl+drag` scales it (text in points, vector/image in mm – the new size is shown in the status bar at the bottom). With `Ctrl+click` select several together, in the list as well as on the page; they get a shared frame and move together.

Button / handle	What it does
Change text, font, size, colour	Rewrite or switch the line; text on a path (single letters on an arc, as from design apps) stays one line: the size changes around the arc's centre, the arc itself is preserved
Scale, move, delete	in the objects tab for vector and image; deleting removes all selected objects at once
One forward/back, to the very front/back	Change the drawing order (z-order) – in all three tabs. Settle overlaps without rebuilding the page; at the limit there is a message instead of breaking anything
Show/hide and reorder layers	Layers tab: visibility per layer (OCG), the same order buttons for the layer blocks. Only the selected page is ever edited
Safety net	After every change Passermark compares before and after: if anything outside the selected objects changes, the change is rolled back and reported

To try it out: the examples folder (section 2, “Fetch examples”) contains the template `vorlage-bogen-text.pdf` – circular text “PASSERMARK” as from a design app, plus two overlapping rectangles for the z-order and a straight line that must not be swept into the arc. Open it, editing workspace, and the pointer list shows all three kinds to practise on.

What does not work: outlined text (without real font information) cannot be edited as text – undo “outline text” beforehand or change it in the originating program. Embedded fonts without readable text information do not appear in the list at all.